



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Monaco. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that—it's great you're already thinking seriously about your next steps! In Denmark, after finishing **primary/lower secondary school (folkeskole)**, you have several main educational paths to choose from, depending on your interests, strengths, and career goals. Here's a breakdown of your options, followed by some tailored advice:

Main Educational Paths After Folkeskole (9th or 10th Grade)

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education – Academic)

These are more theoretical and prepare you for university:

- **STX (Studentereksamen):** General academic track with focus areas like science, humanities, or social sciences.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination):** Focus on business, economics, and marketing.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination):** Focus on science, technology, and innovation.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination):** A shorter, 2-year academic program often used by those who didn't go directly after 9th grade.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (VET – Vocational Education and Training)

These prepare you for specific trades or professions and combine school with apprenticeship in a company (e.g., electrician, chef, mechanic, hairdresser).

3. International/Private Options

You may consider:

- **IB (International Baccalaureate)** in Denmark if you're interested in an international, English-speaking academic path.
- **French or Monégasque school systems**, if your family considers you moving or wants to maintain ties with Monaco.

Your Case: Personal Factors to Consider

- **Language:** You're fluent in Danish, so all Danish programs are open to you.
- **Background:** Having Monegasque roots may open international possibilities later (e.g., studying in France or Monaco).
- **Age:** At 16, you're at a good point to go into either gymnasium or vocational training.
- **Interests:** What subjects do you enjoy most? Do you prefer academic work or practical tasks?
- **Goals:** Do you see yourself at university, or are you more interested in starting work earlier?

Recommended Pathways (Based on Common Goals)

✓ If you want to go to university later:

- **STX:** Great general academic foundation. Good if you're not sure what to study yet.
- **HHX:** Best if you're interested in business, economics, or international trade (can be great for a Monegasque background!).
- **HTX:** Perfect for tech/science-focused students.

✓ If you want a career-oriented, hands-on path:

- **VET (Erhvervsuddannelse):** You get both an education and practical work experience. Denmark has a strong apprenticeship system.

✓ If you're considering international studies:

- **IB Diploma Programme** (in Denmark): Taught in English, internationally recognized, and respected by universities worldwide.

Next Steps

1. **Visit local education fairs (uddannelsesmesser)** or open house events ("åbent hus").
2. **Talk to a UU-vejleder (educational guidance counselor)** – they can help you map your strengths and options.
3. **Explore E-vejledning.dk** or **ug.dk**, where you can compare educations and future job prospects.
4. **Consider a 10th grade (efterskole or normal)** if you're unsure—many use this year to mature and decide.

Final Tip

Ask yourself:

- Do I like studying theoretical subjects or doing practical work?
- Where do I see myself in 5–10 years?
- Would I like to study or work abroad one day?

Let me know your interests (like favorite subjects, hobbies, or dream jobs), and I can give a more specific recommendation!